

Outcome Weights for Kappa-Based LATE Estimators

A Step-by-Step Derivation in the PIVE Framework of Knaus (2024)

Working Notes

Based on Knaus (2024) and Słoczyński, Uysal & Wooldridge (2024)

Abstract

These notes derive the outcome weights ω_i such that $\hat{\tau} = \sum_i \omega_i Y_i$ for three kappa-based estimators of the Local Average Treatment Effect (LATE): the fully-normalized estimator $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$, the unnormalized Abadie estimator $\hat{\tau}_a$, and the Uysal normalized estimator $\hat{\tau}_u$. The derivation follows the Pseudo-IV Estimator (PIVE) framework of Knaus (2024). For each estimator we state which conditions from Knaus (2024) are needed, explain what those conditions mean in the kappa context, and show step by step whether the outcome weights are fully-normalized ($\sum_i \omega_i D_i = 1$, $\sum_i \omega_i (1 - D_i) = -1$), scale-normalized, or unnormalized.

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1 Setting and Notation

We work in a binary instrumental variables (IV) setting. The observed data for unit $i = 1, \dots, N$ are

$$O_i = (D_i, X_i, Y_i, Z_i)',$$

where $D_i \in \{0, 1\}$ is a binary treatment, $Z_i \in \{0, 1\}$ is a binary instrument, Y_i is the outcome of interest, and X_i is a vector of pre-treatment covariates.

Target parameter. The target is the Local Average Treatment Effect (LATE),

$$\tau_{\text{LATE}} = \mathbb{E}[Y_i(1) - Y_i(0) \mid \text{Complier}_i],$$

where a *complier* is a unit whose treatment status is shifted by the instrument.

Instrument propensity score. Let $p(X_i) = \mathbb{E}[Z_i \mid X_i]$ denote the true instrument propensity score, and $\hat{p}_i = \hat{p}(X_i)$ its estimator (typically logistic regression or CBPS).

Matrix notation. Bold letters denote N -vectors or $N \times N$ matrices. $\mathbf{1}_N$ and $\mathbf{0}_N$ are vectors of ones and zeros of length N . $\mathbf{D} = (D_1, \dots, D_N)'$ and $\mathbf{Y} = (Y_1, \dots, Y_N)'$.

2 The Three Kappa Weights

The entire family of estimators studied in Słoczyński et al. (2024) is built from three scalar weights per observation, first introduced by Abadie (2003):

$$\kappa_i = 1 - D_i \frac{1 - Z_i}{1 - \hat{p}_i} - (1 - D_i) \frac{Z_i}{\hat{p}_i}, \quad (1)$$

$$\kappa_{i1} = D_i \frac{Z_i - \hat{p}_i}{\hat{p}_i(1 - \hat{p}_i)}, \quad (2)$$

$$\kappa_{i0} = (1 - D_i) \frac{(1 - Z_i) - (1 - \hat{p}_i)}{\hat{p}_i(1 - \hat{p}_i)} = -(1 - D_i) \frac{Z_i - \hat{p}_i}{\hat{p}_i(1 - \hat{p}_i)}. \quad (3)$$

Intuition

κ_{i1} is nonzero *only* for treated units ($D_i = 1$). It is positive when $Z_i = 1$ and negative when $Z_i = 0$, isolating the complier contribution from the treated group. κ_{i0} works symmetrically for untreated units ($D_i = 0$). Together, κ_1 and κ_0 identify the complier subpopulation from both directions. Note also that $\kappa_{i1} \cdot (1 - D_i) = 0$ and $\kappa_{i0} \cdot D_i = 0$ for all i — a fact we will use extensively in the normalization proofs.

In vector notation:

$$\boldsymbol{\kappa} = (\kappa_1, \dots, \kappa_N)', \quad \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 = (\kappa_{11}, \dots, \kappa_{N1})', \quad \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0 = (\kappa_{10}, \dots, \kappa_{N0})'.$$

3 The PIVE Framework

Knaus (2024) defines a general class of *Pseudo-IV Estimators* (PIVEs) as estimators solving an empirical moment condition of the form

$$\mathbb{E}_N \left[(\tilde{Y}_i - \hat{\tau} \tilde{D}_i) \tilde{Z}_i \right] = 0, \quad (4)$$

with scalar pseudo-outcome $\tilde{Y}_i = f_Y(O_i; \hat{\eta}_i^Y)$, pseudo-treatment $\tilde{D}_i = f_D(O_i; \hat{\eta}_i^D)$, and pseudo-instrument $\tilde{Z}_i = f_Z(O_i; \hat{\eta}_i^Z)$. Solving (4) yields

$$\hat{\tau} = \frac{\mathbb{E}_N[\tilde{Z}_i \tilde{Y}_i]}{\mathbb{E}_N[\tilde{Z}_i \tilde{D}_i]} = (\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{D}})^{-1} \tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}. \quad (5)$$

Proposition 3.1 (Outcome weights of PIVEs, Knaus 2024, Prop. 1). *If $\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{D}} \neq 0$ and there exists a unique $N \times N$ transformation matrix $\mathbf{T}$ such that $\mathbf{T} \mathbf{Y} = \tilde{\mathbf{Y}}$, then the outcome weights of a PIVE take the closed form*

$$\boldsymbol{\omega}' = (\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{D}})^{-1} \tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \mathbf{T}, \quad (6)$$

so that $\hat{\tau} = \boldsymbol{\omega}' \mathbf{Y} = \sum_{i=1}^N \omega_i Y_i$.

Shortcuts for normalization. To classify the resulting outcome weights, Knaus (2024) provides three matrix shortcuts (Section 4.1):

SC1. $\mathbf{T} \mathbf{1}_N = \mathbf{0}_N$ implies $\sum_i \omega_i = 0$ (necessary for normalization)

SC2. $\mathbf{T} \mathbf{D} = \tilde{\mathbf{D}}$ implies $\sum_i \omega_i D_i = 1$ (treated weights sum to one)

SC3. $\mathbf{T}(\mathbf{1}_N - \mathbf{D}) = -\tilde{\mathbf{D}}$ implies $\sum_i \omega_i (1 - D_i) = -1$ (untreated weights sum to minus one)

Full normalization ($\sum_i \omega_i = 0$, $\sum_i \omega_i D_i = 1$, $\sum_i \omega_i (1 - D_i) = -1$) follows from SC1 + SC2 (since SC3 is then implied by subtraction).

Important caveat for the kappa estimators. Knaus (2024) notes that for $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$, the shortcuts SC1–SC3 via $\mathbf{T}$ alone are *not sufficient* because the normalizing scalars $(\mathbf{1}_N' \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1}$ and $(\mathbf{1}_N' \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1}$ are absorbed into the pseudo-instrument rather than $\mathbf{T}$. We must therefore check the *full weight expression* directly (see Appendix A.4 of Knaus 2024 and Section 6 below).

4 Which Conditions Does Knaus (2024) Introduce?

Knaus (2024) introduces six conditions in Section 4.2.1 that govern when outcome weights exist and what normalization properties they possess. Below we state all six, explain their general content, and note which ones are relevant for the kappa estimators in our context.

Condition 4.1 (Smoother matrix). *A unique smoother matrix exists that produces the outcome nuisance predictions by left-multiplying the outcome vector:*

$$\begin{aligned} (C1a) \quad & \mathbf{S} \mathbf{Y} = \hat{\mathbf{Y}}, \\ (C1b) \quad & \mathbf{S}_0^d \mathbf{Y} = \hat{\mathbf{Y}}^{d_0}, \quad \mathbf{S}_1^d \mathbf{Y} = \hat{\mathbf{Y}}^{d_1}, \\ (C1c) \quad & \mathbf{S}_0^z \mathbf{Y} = \hat{\mathbf{Y}}^{z_0}, \quad \mathbf{S}_1^z \mathbf{Y} = \hat{\mathbf{Y}}^{z_1}. \end{aligned}$$

Purpose: This is the existence condition for outcome weights. Without a smoother matrix, the pseudo-outcome $\tilde{Y}$ cannot be written as $\mathbf{T} \mathbf{Y}$, so Proposition 3.1 does not apply.

In our context: The kappa estimators $\hat{\tau}_a$, $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$, and $\hat{\tau}_u$ involve no outcome regression whatsoever — only Z_i , D_i , and $\hat{p}_i$. Condition 4.1 is therefore **automatically satisfied** (trivially, with the identity matrix as smoother), and outcome weights exist unconditionally.

Condition 4.2 (Covariate matrix with constant). *The covariate matrix $\mathbf{X}$ contains a column of ones as its first column, so that $\mathbf{X}(1, \mathbf{0}'_p)' = \mathbf{1}_N$.*

Purpose: Ensures OLS and TSLS are normalized.

In our context: Not relevant for kappa estimators.

Condition 4.3 (Affine smoother matrix). *All rows of each smoother matrix sum to one: $\mathbf{S}\mathbf{1}_N = \mathbf{S}_0^d\mathbf{1}_N = \mathbf{S}_1^d\mathbf{1}_N = \mathbf{S}_0^z\mathbf{1}_N = \mathbf{S}_1^z\mathbf{1}_N = \mathbf{1}_N$.*

Purpose: Ensures normalized weights for AIPW, PLR, and causal/instrumental forests. Most regression smoothers (random forests, kernel regression, ridge) satisfy this; boosted trees may not.

In our context: Not directly required for kappa estimators, but the analogous role is played by the explicit normalization built into $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$ and $\hat{\tau}_u$.

Condition 4.4 (No smoothing between treatment groups). *Predictions $\hat{Y}^{d_1}$ are formed using treated units only, and $\hat{Y}^{d_0}$ using untreated units only: $\mathbf{S}_1^d(\mathbf{1}_N - \mathbf{D}) = \mathbf{0}_N$ and $\mathbf{S}_0^d\mathbf{D} = \mathbf{0}_N$.*

Purpose: Ensures AIPW is fully normalized.

In our context: Not relevant for kappa estimators.

Condition 4.5 (Outcome smoother applied to treatment).

$$(C5a) \quad \mathbf{S}\mathbf{D} = \hat{\mathbf{D}},$$

$$(C5b) \quad \mathbf{S}_1^z\mathbf{D} = \hat{\mathbf{D}}^{z_1}, \quad \mathbf{S}_0^z\mathbf{D} = \hat{\mathbf{D}}^{z_0}.$$

Purpose: Ensures full normalization for PLR, causal/instrumental forests (C5a), and Wald-AIPW (C5b). This requires using the same model to predict both outcome and treatment, which conflicts with standard flexible implementations.

In our context: Not relevant for kappa estimators.

Condition 4.6 (Normalized IPW weights).

$$(C6a) \quad \lambda_{1,i}^{\text{norm}} = \lambda_{1,i}^{\text{ipw}} / \mathbb{E}_N[\lambda_1^{\text{ipw}}], \quad \mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\lambda}_1^{\text{norm}} = \mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\lambda}_0^{\text{norm}} = N,$$

$$(C6b) \quad \text{analogous normalization for instrument-group IPW weights.}$$

Purpose: Ensures full normalization for standard IPW (C6a) and Wald-IPW (C6b). This is the Hájek (1971) normalization.

In our context: $\hat{\tau}_u$ is the direct analogue of Wald-IPW with C6b applied. The separate normalization in $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$ is a different mechanism that achieves the same effect without explicitly invoking C6b.

Summary for kappa estimators

Among the six conditions, only the trivial case of Condition 4.1 matters for the kappa estimators. No smoother for outcome regressions is needed, so outcome weights always exist. Normalization properties then follow purely from the algebraic structure of the kappa weights themselves. Conditions 4.2–4.5 are irrelevant. Condition 4.6 is implicitly used by $\hat{\tau}_u$.

5 The Five Estimators

Słoczyński et al. (2024) study five estimators. In vector form, using the kappa definitions from Section 2:

$$\hat{\tau}_a = (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa})^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) \mathbf{Y}, \quad (7)$$

$$\hat{\tau}_{a,1} = (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) \mathbf{Y}, \quad (8)$$

$$\hat{\tau}_{a,0} = (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) \mathbf{Y}, \quad (9)$$

$$\hat{\tau}_{a,10} = N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \text{diag}[\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} N - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1} N] \mathbf{Y}, \quad (10)$$

$$\hat{\tau}_u = \frac{\left(\sum_i \frac{Z_i}{\hat{p}_i} \right)^{-1} \sum_i \frac{Z_i Y_i}{\hat{p}_i} - \left(\sum_i \frac{1 - Z_i}{1 - \hat{p}_i} \right)^{-1} \sum_i \frac{(1 - Z_i) Y_i}{1 - \hat{p}_i}}{\left(\sum_i \frac{Z_i}{\hat{p}_i} \right)^{-1} \sum_i \frac{Z_i D_i}{\hat{p}_i} - \left(\sum_i \frac{1 - Z_i}{1 - \hat{p}_i} \right)^{-1} \sum_i \frac{(1 - Z_i) D_i}{1 - \hat{p}_i}}. \quad (11)$$

Estimators (7)–(9) share the same numerator $\mathbf{1}'_N \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) \mathbf{Y}$ but use different denominators. In scalar form:

$$\hat{\tau}_a = \frac{\bar{\kappa}_1 - \bar{\kappa}_0}{\bar{\kappa}}, \quad \hat{\tau}_{a,1} = \frac{\bar{\kappa}_1 - \bar{\kappa}_0}{\bar{\kappa}_1}, \quad \hat{\tau}_{a,0} = \frac{\bar{\kappa}_1 - \bar{\kappa}_0}{\bar{\kappa}_0},$$

where $\bar{\kappa} = N^{-1} \sum_i \kappa_i Y_i$ and so on.

6 Derivation: $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$

6.1 PIVE representation

Write (10) compactly as

$$\hat{\tau}_{a,10} = N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \underbrace{\text{diag}[\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} N - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1} N]}_{=: \mathbf{T}^{a,10}} \mathbf{Y}. \quad (12)$$

Matching to the PIVE structure (5):

- $\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' = N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N$ (pseudo-instrument is constant $1/N$ per observation),
- $\tilde{\mathbf{D}} = \mathbf{1}_N$ (pseudo-treatment is identically one),
- $\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{D}} = N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \mathbf{1}_N = 1$ (normalizing scalar = 1),
- $\mathbf{T}^{a,10} = \text{diag}[\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} N - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1} N]$.

Since the kappa weights are purely functions of Z_i , D_i , $\hat{p}_i$ and *not* of Y_i , the smoother matrix is trivially available (Condition 4.1 holds without restriction). By Proposition 3.1, the outcome weights are:

$$\boldsymbol{\omega}^{a,10'} = (\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{D}})^{-1} \tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \mathbf{T}^{a,10} = N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \text{diag}[\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} N - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0(\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1} N]. \quad (13)$$

The per-observation outcome weight is therefore

$$\omega_i^{a,10} = \frac{\kappa_{i1}}{\sum_j \kappa_{j1}} - \frac{\kappa_{i0}}{\sum_j \kappa_{j0}}. \quad (14)$$

Interpretation

Each observation's weight is its share of the treated-side kappa minus its share of the untreated-side kappa. Treated units ($D_i = 1$) receive positive weight through κ_{i1} ; untreated units ($D_i = 0$) receive negative weight through $-\kappa_{i0}$. Units with $D_i = 1$ and $Z_i = 0$ (defiers in a no-defiers world, or always-takers) get negative weight via $\kappa_{i1} < 0$.

6.2 Normalization: weights sum to zero

We check normalization by computing $\sum_i \omega_i^{a,10}$ directly from (13) (the transformation-matrix shortcut SC1 is not sufficient here because the normalizing scalars sit outside $\mathbf{T}$, as noted in Section 3).

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_i \omega_i^{a,10} &= N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \mathbf{T}^{a,10} \mathbf{1}_N \\ &= N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N [\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} N - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0 (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1} N] \\ &= N^{-1} [N (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1) (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} - N (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1}] \\ &= N^{-1} [N - N] = 0. \quad \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

$\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$ is normalized (no conditions required)

$\sum_{i=1}^N \omega_i^{a,10} = 0$. This follows unconditionally from the built-in normalization of $\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1$ and $\boldsymbol{\kappa}_0$ in (10). No smoother condition (C1–C3) or IPW normalization condition (C6) is needed.

6.3 Full normalization: treated weights sum to one

We compute $\sum_i \omega_i^{a,10} D_i$ directly:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_i \omega_i^{a,10} D_i &= N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \mathbf{T}^{a,10} \mathbf{D} \\ &= N^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N [\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} N - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0 (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)^{-1} N] \circ \mathbf{D} \end{aligned}$$

where $\circ$ denotes element-wise multiplication. Since $\kappa_{i0}(D_i = 1) = 0$ for all i (untreated-side kappa is zero for treated units), and $\kappa_{i1}(D_i = 1) = \kappa_{i1}$ (treated-side kappa is zero for untreated, so multiplying by D keeps it):

$$\begin{aligned} &= N^{-1} [N (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1)^{-1} (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1) - 0] \\ &= N^{-1} \cdot N = 1. \quad \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

$\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$ is fully normalized (no conditions required)

$\sum_{i=1}^N \omega_i^{a,10} D_i = 1$. Combined with $\sum_i \omega_i^{a,10} = 0$, it follows by subtraction that $\sum_{i=1}^N \omega_i^{a,10} (1 - D_i) = -1$. **Full normalization holds unconditionally** — no conditions from Knaus (2024) need to be invoked. This stands in contrast to PLR, causal forests, and Wald-AIPW, which require Conditions 4.3 and 4.5 to achieve the same property.

7 Derivation: $\hat{\tau}_a$ (Fully Unnormalized)

7.1 PIVE representation

From (7), the estimator in PIVE form is:

$$\hat{\tau}_a = (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa})^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \underbrace{\text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)}_{=: \mathbf{T}^a} \mathbf{Y}. \quad (15)$$

Matching to (5):

- $\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' = \mathbf{1}'_N$,
- $\tilde{\mathbf{D}} = \boldsymbol{\kappa}$,
- $\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{D}} = \mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa}$,
- $\mathbf{T}^a = \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0)$.

By Proposition 3.1:

$$\boldsymbol{\omega}^{a'} = (\mathbf{1}'_N \boldsymbol{\kappa})^{-1} \mathbf{1}'_N \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0), \quad \text{i.e.} \quad \omega_i^a = \frac{\kappa_{i1} - \kappa_{i0}}{\sum_j \kappa_j}. \quad (16)$$

Again, Condition 4.1 holds trivially since no outcome regression is involved.

7.2 Checking normalization via Shortcut SC1

We apply SC1 by checking $\mathbf{T}^a \mathbf{1}_N$:

$$\mathbf{T}^a \mathbf{1}_N = \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) \mathbf{1}_N = \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0.$$

This is *not* the zero vector in general, since $\kappa_{i1} - \kappa_{i0} \neq 0$ whenever $Z_i \neq \hat{p}_i$. Therefore SC1 fails, and $\sum_i \omega_i^a \neq 0$ in general.

$\hat{\tau}_a$ is not normalized

$\mathbf{T}^a \mathbf{1}_N = \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0 \neq \mathbf{0}_N$ in general. Hence $\sum_i \omega_i^a \neq 0$, so $\hat{\tau}_a$ is **not normalized**. No additional conditions can fix this — it is a structural feature of the estimator.

7.3 Checking SC2: treated weights

We apply SC2 by checking whether $\mathbf{T}^a \mathbf{D} = \tilde{\mathbf{D}} = \boldsymbol{\kappa}$:

$$\mathbf{T}^a \mathbf{D} = \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) \mathbf{D} = \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 \circ \mathbf{D} - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0 \circ \mathbf{D}.$$

Since $\kappa_{i0} D_i = 0$ for all i :

$$\mathbf{T}^a \mathbf{D} = \boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 \neq \boldsymbol{\kappa} = \tilde{\mathbf{D}}^a.$$

SC2 fails. Together with SC1 failing, we check SC3:

$$\mathbf{T}^a (\mathbf{1}_N - \mathbf{D}) = \text{diag}(\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) (\mathbf{1}_N - \mathbf{D}) = (\boldsymbol{\kappa}_1 - \boldsymbol{\kappa}_0) \circ (\mathbf{1}_N - \mathbf{D}).$$

Since $\kappa_{i1}(1 - D_i) = 0$ for all i :

$$\mathbf{T}^a (\mathbf{1}_N - \mathbf{D}) = -\boldsymbol{\kappa}_0.$$

Is $-\boldsymbol{\kappa}_0 = -\tilde{\mathbf{D}}^a = -\boldsymbol{\kappa}$? No, since $\kappa_i \neq \kappa_{i0}$ in general. SC3 also fails, confirming that $\hat{\tau}_a$ is **fully unnormalized**.

$\hat{\tau}_a$ is fully unnormalized

All three shortcut checks fail:

$$\sum_i \omega_i^a \neq 0, \quad \sum_i \omega_i^a D_i \neq 1, \quad \sum_i \omega_i^a (1 - D_i) \neq -1 \quad \text{in general.}$$

This confirms the classification in Knaus (2024, Appendix A.4) and SUW (2024). The practical implication is that $\hat{\tau}_a$ is not translation invariant: adding a constant c to every Y_i changes the estimate.

8 Derivation: $\hat{\tau}_u$ (Uysal Normalized)

8.1 Scalar form and PIVE representation

The Uysal (2011) estimator (11) can be rewritten as a Wald ratio of two Hájek-normalized IPW estimators for the ATE of Z on Y and on D :

$$\hat{\tau}_u = \frac{\mu_{Y,1}^{\text{norm}} - \mu_{Y,0}^{\text{norm}}}{\mu_{D,1}^{\text{norm}} - \mu_{D,0}^{\text{norm}}}, \quad (17)$$

where

$$\mu_{Y,1}^{\text{norm}} = \frac{\sum_i Z_i Y_i / \hat{p}_i}{\sum_i Z_i / \hat{p}_i}, \quad \mu_{Y,0}^{\text{norm}} = \frac{\sum_i (1 - Z_i) Y_i / (1 - \hat{p}_i)}{\sum_i (1 - Z_i) / (1 - \hat{p}_i)},$$

and analogously for $\mu_{D,\cdot}^{\text{norm}}$.

Define the normalizing sums

$$s_1 = \sum_i \frac{Z_i}{\hat{p}_i}, \quad s_0 = \sum_i \frac{1 - Z_i}{1 - \hat{p}_i}.$$

The pseudo-outcome is

$$\tilde{Y}_i^u = \frac{Z_i}{\hat{p}_i s_1} Y_i - \frac{1 - Z_i}{(1 - \hat{p}_i) s_0} Y_i = \underbrace{\left(\frac{Z_i}{\hat{p}_i s_1} - \frac{1 - Z_i}{(1 - \hat{p}_i) s_0} \right)}_{=: m_i} Y_i, \quad (18)$$

which defines a diagonal transformation matrix $\mathbf{T}^u = \text{diag}(m_1, \dots, m_N)$. The pseudo-treatment is

$$\tilde{D}_i^u = \frac{Z_i D_i}{\hat{p}_i s_1} - \frac{(1 - Z_i) D_i}{(1 - \hat{p}_i) s_0},$$

and the pseudo-instrument is $\tilde{Z}_i^u = 1$. The PIVE normalizing scalar is

$$\tilde{\mathbf{Z}}' \tilde{\mathbf{D}} = \mathbf{1}'_N \tilde{\mathbf{D}}^u = \mu_{D,1}^{\text{norm}} - \mu_{D,0}^{\text{norm}} =: \Delta_D.$$

By Proposition 3.1, the outcome weights are:

$$\boxed{\omega_i^u = \frac{m_i}{\Delta_D} = \frac{1}{\Delta_D} \left(\frac{Z_i}{\hat{p}_i s_1} - \frac{1 - Z_i}{(1 - \hat{p}_i) s_0} \right)}. \quad (19)$$

8.2 Checking normalization via SC1

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_i \omega_i^u &= \frac{1}{\Delta_D} \sum_i m_i = \frac{1}{\Delta_D} \left(\frac{\sum_i Z_i / \hat{p}_i}{s_1} - \frac{\sum_i (1 - Z_i) / (1 - \hat{p}_i)}{s_0} \right) \\ &= \frac{1}{\Delta_D} (1 - 1) = 0. \quad \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

So SC1 holds and $\hat{\tau}_u$ is normalized. This uses the Hájek normalization implicit in s_1 and s_0 , which is precisely Condition 4.6(C6b) applied to instrument groups.

8.3 Checking full normalization via SC2

We check whether $\sum_i \omega_i^u D_i = 1$:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_i \omega_i^u D_i &= \frac{1}{\Delta_D} \sum_i m_i D_i = \frac{1}{\Delta_D} \left(\frac{\sum_i Z_i D_i / \hat{p}_i}{s_1} - \frac{\sum_i (1 - Z_i) D_i / (1 - \hat{p}_i)}{s_0} \right) \\ &= \frac{\mu_{D,1}^{\text{norm}} - \mu_{D,0}^{\text{norm}}}{\Delta_D} = \frac{\Delta_D}{\Delta_D} = 1. \quad \checkmark \end{aligned}$$

$\hat{\tau}_u$ is fully normalized

$\sum_i \omega_i^u = 0$ and $\sum_i \omega_i^u D_i = 1$, so $\sum_i \omega_i^u (1 - D_i) = -1$ follows by subtraction.

What condition enables this? The Hájek-type normalization by s_1 and s_0 , which corresponds to Condition 4.6(C6b) from Knaus (2024). Without this normalization (i.e. if we used raw IPW weights $Z_i / \hat{p}_i$ without dividing by s_1), the weights would be fully unnormalized — this is exactly the gap between $\hat{\tau}_t = \hat{\tau}_{a,1}$ and $\hat{\tau}_u$ in the SUW taxonomy.

Table 1: Outcome weights: existence, form, and normalization

Estimator	Closed-form	$\sum_i \omega_i$	$\sum_i \omega_i D_i$	$\sum_i \omega_i (1 - D_i)$
$\hat{\tau}_a$	✓ (unconditional)	$\neq 0$	$\neq 1$	$\neq -1$
$\hat{\tau}_{a,0}$	✓ (unconditional)	$\neq 0$	$\neq 1$	$= -1$
$\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$	✓ (unconditional)	$= 0$	$= 1$	$= -1$
$\hat{\tau}_u$	✓ (unconditional)	$= 0$	$= 1$	$= -1$

Notes: $\hat{\tau}_{a,1}$ (Tan/Frölich estimator) equals $\hat{\tau}_a$ rescaled and is also fully unnormalized. Normalization classification follows Knaus (2024), Table 4.

9 Summary and Comparison

Table 1 collects the results for all three estimators.

Why $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$ and $\hat{\tau}_u$ achieve full normalization by different routes:

- $\hat{\tau}_{a,10}$ achieves full normalization by *separately* normalizing the κ_1 and κ_0 weighted sums. Each half sums to 1 and -1 respectively by construction, and the cancellation is exact. No condition from Knaus (2024) needs to be invoked — normalization is built in algebraically.
- $\hat{\tau}_u$ achieves full normalization via Hájek normalization of the IPW weights, corresponding to Condition 4.6(C6b). The analogy in Knaus (2024) is Wald-IPW with C6b applied (Table 5, Knaus 2024).
- $\hat{\tau}_a$ and $\hat{\tau}_{a,1}$ use a single shared denominator that does not separately normalize the treated and untreated contributions, so neither the sum-to-zero nor the group-level conditions are met.

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